OpsDesk for TBO: Competitor Research

TBO Hackathon | Problem statement: OpsDesk (Zendesk replacement) | Compiled from vendor help docs

1. Purpose and approach

The brief says today's ticketing system (Zendesk) treats tickets as isolated tasks and falls short on six problems: context/linking, routing, side conversations, SLA/escalation, insights, and data export/archival. We compared Zendesk, Freshdesk and Jira Service Management (JSM) on those problems, using their own documentation, to find what they do, what they need (plans, add-ons, custom rules), and what they do not understand about TBO's world: agency, booking ID (TBOH), check-in date and last cancellation date (LCD).

2. Key finding in one line

All three tools are strong at generic support (routing by group, SLA by priority, timer-based escalation). None has built-in concepts for agency, TBOH, check-in date or LCD. Reaching the brief's goals would mean higher plans, add-ons, third-party apps or custom rules. OpsDesk's argument is travel context built in, not that competitors lack routing or AI.

3. Comparison by problem

Brief problem	Zendesk	Freshdesk	Jira Service Mgmt	Gap OpsDesk fills
1. Ticket linking and context	Linking found is ticket to Jira issue via the Jira integration, with custom fields needed to track counts. Described as a bolt-on.	Parent-child tickets and "Tracker" (master ticket with related tickets). Agents link manually; unlinking is permanent. Restricted agents may not see linked tickets.	Automation actions "Link work items" and "Lookup work items" (JQL, up to 100). Needs custom rules.	Automatic linking by agency, TBOH and intent as a first-class feature, no manual stitching.
2. Routing and ownership	Omnichannel routing: group, agent status, capacity, skills. Only new/open tickets routed. Priority ordering and custom queues need Professional+. Email tickets need triggers and a routing tag.	Auto-assignment within a group (round robin) plus advanced routing (Omniroute). Logged-out agents are skipped.	Automation "Assign work item": round robin, balanced workload, random, user in role/group, on-call. Very flexible but every rule is hand-built.	Built-in routing by region, time window, ranking and availability, with a visible "why routed" reason.
3. Side conversations	Needs Collaboration add-on on higher plans. Parent ticket's assignee is always shown as a recipient even if removed from To. End-user replies do not notify the assignee unless a trigger is built.	No side-conversation feature found in docs search. Collaboration appears via Slack/Teams apps.	Not researched in detail.	Explicit recipient list per thread that survives transfer; internal notes vs external replies kept distinct.

Brief problem	Zendesk	Freshdesk	Jira Service Mgmt	Gap OpsDesk fills
4. SLA	SLA by ticket priority and business/calendar hours. Priority must be set or no SLA applies. No triggers or agent notifications on SLA breach (automations with "hours until breach" only). Group SLAs are Enterprise only.	SLA policies on Growth/Pro/Enterprise. Conditions like group, type, company. First matching policy wins, so order matters.	SLA goals per request type with conditions and calendars that start, pause or stop the clock. Intro article does not mention a date field.	SLA clock driven by check-in date and LCD proximity plus priority, with at-risk/breached flags on the queue.
4. Escalation	Official recipe uses triggers on comment keywords, bad CSAT, or more than 3 agent replies, then moves the ticket to an Escalations group.	Escalation rules and supervisor rules send time-based notifications; multiple levels. Group settings can email after a set time.	Docs found cover alert/on-call escalation, not normal ticket escalation. Not a fair comparison.	Escalate to a named Escalation Manager as a first-class action that changes owner/queue and shows on the timeline.
5. Insights loop	Insights dashboard is for AI agent performance and is legacy (ends Dec 10, 2026). Explore live dashboards are Enterprise only and being removed Jan 25, 2027.	Curated Reports cover AI agent conversations (resolution, handover).	Not researched.	Lightweight themes view (e.g. refund delay, inventory sync) with sample tickets, built from conversations.
6. Data export / archival	Exports must be enabled via Zendesk Support and are not on Team plans. CSV excludes comments and some custom fields. XML capped near 200k tickets. Tickets over 1 MB lose comments in JSON.	Automatic ticket archiving after a set number of days; archived tickets can be found and exported.	Not researched.	Queryable export/API without artificial caps (documented scale path), clear retention and archival stance.

4. What to verify before claiming it

- **The brief's "3K-row export cap"** is not stated in the Zendesk docs we read. In the pitch say "per the brief", not as a Zendesk fact.
- **Freshdesk escalation:** a snippet says escalation is only to agents (cut off). Open the article and check whether it can assign to a named manager or only send email.
- **Freshdesk side conversations:** we found nothing in the docs search. Word it as "not found in docs", not "does not exist".
- **Jira SLA:** only the intro article was read. Say "no date-field clock found in docs read" rather than "cannot".
- **Jira linked-issues bug:** the pasted bug report is closed and fixed. Do not cite it as a current problem.
- Most findings come from search snippets and a few full articles. Re-check any figure on the live page before it goes in a slide.

5. Pitch angle

Zendesk, Freshdesk and Jira can each be configured toward parts of this, but none understands agency, booking ID (TBOH), check-in date or LCD out of the box. Each needs plan upgrades, add-ons or custom rules. OpsDesk has travel context built in: cases linked by agency, TBOH and intent; routing by region, time

and availability; travel-aware SLAs; direct escalation to Escalation Managers.

6. Sources used (vendor help docs)

- Zendesk: About SLA policies; Using SLA policies; About omnichannel routing; About side conversations; Managing your escalation queue; Exporting ticket, user or organization data; Insights dashboard (legacy); Live data limits for Explore; Jira linked-ticket reporting.
- Freshdesk (support.freshdesk.com): automatic ticket assignment / round robin; Omniroute; Understanding SLA policies; escalation rules; Linked Tickets / Tracker; parent-child tickets; ticket archiving; Slack app.
- Atlassian (support.atlassian.com): What are SLAs?; Jira automation actions; escalate an alert (alerts only).